

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 39 OF 86

Glinski's Hexagonal Chess

hex radius 5

BOARD

2

PLAYERS

GLINSKI'S HEXAGONAL CHESS

Created by Wladyslaw Glinski in 1936, this is the most popular hexagonal chess variant. Played on a 91-cell hexagonal board (radius 5 in axial coordinates), it adapts all standard chess pieces to hex geometry.

BOARD

A regular hexagon composed of 91 hexagonal cells arranged in concentric rings. Cells come in three colours (light, medium, dark) following the hex-alternation pattern — each bishop is bound to one colour.

SETUP

White pieces (starting from the bottom):

- ♦ King on f1
- ♦ Queen on e1
- ♦ Bishops on d1, f2, g2 (one per colour)
- ♦ Knights on c1, g1
- ♦ Rooks on b1, h1
- ♦ Pawns on b2, c2, d2, e2, f3, g3, h3, i2, j2 (9 pawns)

Black pieces (mirrored at the top):

- ♦ King on f11
- ♦ Queen on g11
- ♦ Bishops on h11, f10, e10 (one per colour)
- ♦ Knights on i11, e11
- ♦ Rooks on j11, d11
- ♦ Pawns on j10, i10, h10, g10, f9, e9, d9, c10, b10 (9 pawns)

PIECES

Rook — slides along any of 6 orthogonal hex edges (the 6 directions adjacent cells touch). Equivalent to a rook on a square board but with 6 directions instead of 4.

Bishop — slides along any of 6 diagonal hex directions (vertex-to-vertex, skipping the adjacent cell). Colour-bound — never leaves its starting cell colour.

Queen — combines rook and bishop movement (all 12 hex directions).

King — moves one step in any of the 12 directions (6 edges + 6 vertices).

Knight — leaps to any cell exactly 2 orthogonal steps and 1 turn away. From a centre cell, a knight threatens 12 cells (compared to 8 on a square board). Offsets in axial coordinates: (2,-1), (1,-2), (-1,-1), (-2,1), (-1,2), (1,1) and their reflections.

Pawn — advances toward the opponent’s edge of the board. Can move one hex forward (toward far edge) or capture one hex diagonally-forward. No double-step and no en passant in Glinski’s original rules. Promotion occurs when a pawn reaches any cell on the far edge of the board.

RULES

- ♦ Standard chess rules apply for check, checkmate, and stalemate
- ♦ No castling (king starts centrally, no rook-corner relationship)
- ♦ No en passant (no double pawn step)
- ♦ Pawns promote on the far edge (the opposite rim of the hexagon from their starting position)
- ♦ Three bishops per side — one for each hex cell colour
- ♦ Stalemate is a draw

KEY DIFFERENCES FROM SQUARE CHESS

CONCEPT	SQUARE BOARD	HEX BOARD
Rook directions	4 (orthogonal)	6 (hex edges)
Bishop directions	4 (diagonal)	6 (hex vertices)
Knight targets	8	12
Bishop colours	2	3
Pawns per side	8	9
Board cells	64	91